be uncooperative and not want to settle anything with the Soviets. I can't agree on that. One thing I do know is, I won't trade our SDI off for some Soviet offer of weapon reductions. . . . Got fitted for a new bulletproof raincoat and went home."

After Eduard Shevardnadze came to Washington with the letter from Gorbachev, to make preparations for the summit, I subsequently saw him briefly at the United Nations in New York and noted afterward in my diary: "He's a personable fellow, but we had our differences. My goal was to send him back to Gorbachev with a message that I really meant 'arms reductions'; for the first time, they talked *real* verification procedures. Now I have to decide how to respond to Gorbachev's letter to me."

After an NSPG meeting at which various options were discussed on how to respond to Gorbachev's proposal for a fifty-percent reduction in nuclear weapons—the same proposal I'd made in 1983—1 wrote:

"My idea is that we undermine their propaganda plan by offering a counter proposal which stresses our acceptance of some of their figures, such as a 50 percent cut in weapons and a total of 6000 warheads, etc. Those are pretty much like what we've already proposed."

Here are excerpts from my reply to Gorbachev's letter, which summarized much of our position on the eve of the meeting in Geneva:

Dear Mr. General Secretary:

As I told Foreign Minister Shevardnadze in New York October 24, I have given careful consideration to your letter dated September 12. The issues you raised are important ones, the ideas you have put forward are in many ways interesting, and I have wanted to study them thoroughly before replying.